

September

24



1957

Little Rock Nine

In Arkansas, USA, after racial segregation had been prohibited by the US Supreme Court, US Army soldiers stepped in to protect nine Black American students who were being prevented from attending the previously white-only Little Rock High School by a white mob.

Test of endurance

The first modern-day triathlon was held in California, USA. Contestants ran 8.5 km (5.3 miles), then cycled for 8 km (5 miles), and finally swam 548 m (1,800 ft) in the Pacific Ocean to complete the race.

1974



Born this day

1936 Jim Henson, US puppeteer and filmmaker. He created the popular TV puppet characters called the Muppets, including Kermit the Frog, Miss Piggy, and Cookie Monster.

Also on this day

1852 A steam-powered airship, built by French engineer Henri Giffard, took its first flight from Paris to Elancourt, France, travelling 27 km (17 miles) at a speed of 10 kph (6 mph).

1948 Japanese industrialist Soichiro Honda founded The Honda Motor Company.

2014 India's *Mangalyaan* space probe entered orbit around Mars after a 298-day journey, making India the first country in the world to achieve this feat on its first attempt.

1906

First national monument

US president Theodore Roosevelt declared Devils Tower, a 1,558 m (5,112 ft) tall igneous rock formation in Wyoming, USA, as the first US national monument, now protected by the US National Park Service.

